

CSS Introduction

Learning Objectives

- Explain the role of CSS in separating content from presentation
- Apply inline, internal, and external CSS to style HTML elements
- Link an external stylesheet to an HTML document

Engage (5-7 minutes)

HTML provides structure, but without styling every page looks the same—black text on white background. CSS (Cascading Style Sheets) is the paint that transforms a plain skeleton into a visually appealing design.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Create an HTML page and apply styling three ways: inline using style attribute on a heading, internal using a style tag in the head, and external by linking a separate .css file. Observe how external styling keeps HTML clean and enables site-wide design changes.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

CSS controls visual presentation—colors, fonts, spacing, and layout. Inline styles apply to individual elements using the style attribute. Internal styles use a style tag in the head section for page-specific styling. External stylesheets use a link tag to connect a .css file—the most maintainable approach for multi-page websites.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Convert an existing HTML page by removing all inline styles. Create an external stylesheet with rules for headings, paragraphs, links, and body. Link it to the HTML page and verify all styles apply correctly. Explain why external stylesheets are preferred in professional development.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Create a styled page using only an external CSS file. Verify the link tag is correctly placed in the head section. Explain one advantage of external CSS over inline styles and one advantage over internal styles.